

A black and white artistic photograph. In the foreground, a crystal glass with a faceted stem and base sits on a surface with a black and white checkered pattern. The glass is partially filled with liquid, and its facets reflect the light. In the background, a small globe is visible, also resting on the checkered surface. The overall composition is dramatic and high-contrast.

Creative Writing Collaborative  
Presents:

**MYSTERY  
STORIES**

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## ~ Spotlight Stories ~

# THE MISSING GEM RING

BY: MEGHNA SRIVARSHINI

Once upon a time, there was a detective group called “The Investigation Guys,” IG for short. They were awesome detectives all around the world and there were three people in the group whose names were Gale, Billy and Sump. Sump was the smart guy of the group, Billy was the translator because they solved mysteries all around the world, and Gale was the Science guy.

In Paris, France there was a jewelry shop called Crystal Shop and inside that Crystal Shop there was a safe in the walls and inside that safe was a Gem Ring. The name Gem Ring was given because it had all of the gems in the world and it had precious metal and it was the only Gem Ring in the universe! The safe had a fingerprint detector and the fingerprint was Dr. Jonathan's. He was the manager of the shop and he was meaning to give it to his wife.

Dr. Jonathan was very smart to put it in the walls so no one would notice it, and only the people who worked at Crystal Shop would know where it was, but it was only Dr. Jonathan's fingerprint that could open it.

The day before he was going to propose to his wife he knew he had to get a good night's sleep so he slept at 6 p.m. and then the next morning at 6 a.m. he was going to the Crystal Shop to get the ring. Soon, when he got there he realized that the door was open and then, when he went inside the safe was wide open and the Gem Ring was gone!

Dr. Jonathan was terrified the moment he saw that the Gem Ring was gone. He dialed 911 on his phone and the police came right away to investigate. Dr. Jonathan knew that the police weren't enough so he went online and saw the IG (Investigation Guys). He found the phone number and called right away. The IG got the call and headed straight for Paris.

After a couple of hours, they arrived at Paris and they headed straight for Crystal Shop. After 30 minutes they arrived at the Crystal Shop and Dr. Jonathan was very panicked. Dr. Jonathan had already told them what had happened so they started investigating.

In Paris, everyone spoke French so Billy translated, but Dr. Jonathan and the other police officers knew English, so Billy did not have to translate. Gale asked if they should check the security camera footage, Dr. Jonathan was in a huge panic that he never even thought of it. So Gale opened his laptop and checked the security camera footage, but all they saw was a black figure moving.

“Are there other security cameras around the shop?” Gale asked.

“Yes, there are three more. One is outside the door, the next one is above the Gem Ring and the last one is below the Gem Ring.”

“Thanks.” said Gale. Gale saw the security camera footage above the Gem Ring but the victim kept his hood up and his face was looking at the Gem Ring. Then, Gale checked the camera below the Gem Ring and they saw the guy who stole the Gem Ring. The guy had a bushy

mustache, but he was skinny and he was bald. Gale took a picture of him on his phone and then researched him online. His name was Philip Forken. Then, Gale checked the camera above the door outside. They saw Phillip Forken. He was carrying a bag, which was probably where the Gem Ring was and they saw him hopping into his car and driving off. Gale rewinded the camera and saw his license plate. There was a word and it said "GEMS!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!"

It seemed as though Phillip Forken had always wanted the Gem Ring. Sump got Phillip Forken's fingerprints and he put it on a piece of cardboard. The police were very surprised by the IG's intelligence and they said, "We could use people like you in our team. Would you guys like to join?" said officer Frank who led the team.

The IG thought about it and they did not join because they traveled all around the world while police stayed in Paris so they could not join.

"It is not over yet we still have to catch the culprit," said Billy.

"Billy is right and also I got his license plate so we know who he is and Sump got his fingerprint so I can find out where he lives," said Gale.

"Found it. So it says that he lives at 204 Wescott Drive. Wow. I would never want to buy such a small looking house, I've always wanted a humongous mansion," said Officer Frank. They took the limo that Dr. Jonathan had and drove to 204 Wescott Drive. The police crew came with us and after ten minutes, they got there but it said that you need a fingerprint to enter the house.

Gale said, "Wait Sump didn't you collect the fingerprint earlier?"

"Oh ya." Sump got out the fingerprint but it did not work.

Then, Sump got curious and asked "Officer Frank why don't you try putting your fingerprint on the scanner and see if it works?"

"Why would it open with my fingerprint."

"It is better than doing nothing," said Sump.

"Ok fine I will try." Officer Frank placed his thumb on the scanner and the door opened. "How unusual," said Officer Frank.

When they got inside Gale asked "How did you know that Officer Franks fingerprint would open the door?"

"Lucky guess." said Sump. They found Phillip Forken watching TV while eating popcorn. They saw him, captured him, and tied him up to a chair and asked him questions.

Sump asked, "Why do you want the Gem Ring?"

"I was just following orders," said Phillip.

"Whose orders?" asked Sump, "I can't say and I don't know."

"What do you mean you don't know?" asked Billy.

"There was a letter slipped under my door and it said: *Steal the Gem Ring from Crystal Shop. I have a map for you to follow. Use my car and come to the house. When you are done, I will give you 100 dollars,*" said Phillip.

"Wow this really is a very small house," said Gale.

“It is on that table,” Phillip said. Sump took the letter, found a fingerprint and then asked

Gale took out his computer and did his *stuff* and then he said that the fingerprint belongs to Frank.

“That can’t be,” said Billy, “Wait a second. Actually, I think he does know what he did. I remember when he said that he wanted a humongous mansion instead of a small house like this, he was going to use the Gem Ring to buy a big house.

Soon, people started to understand and Dr. Jonathan asked “Is this true?”

Officer Frank went to jail, but Phillip did not because he promised not to do anything like this again and the Investigation Guys carried on with their work of solving mysteries.

**By ETHAN ZHANG**

You might know about Detective - wait - you probably don't know about Detective ??????. Yep. Detective?????. Can you call him just Detective? Or do you need the ????? You can just call him ? for now. And you probably don't know about villan 10987234, but you can call him 109.

? was coming back from his super secret meeting with the president in the empire state bulding and received \$1,000,000,000,000,000 because he solved every crime in the BIN (AKA File bin of hardest unsolved crimes). He was going back to the shack (AKA his house, which was in Trenton, NJ), but inside the shack was an elevator that led to his ...

## 3

So... remember that cliffhanger in the last chapter. If you do, you would remember an elevator that leads to ?'s secret base. Nevermind, you didn't know that. So ? was in his secret base called ?HQ and he was searching for the latest crimes in North America, but there was none. Just then, there was a tiny rumble and out of nowhere, there was a massive number of crimes!

### Chapter III - A Crime

He went to the first one in the museum and he saw nothing besides smoke and a screwdriver. But then out of the smoke, a music box emerged. Then, he went to the next crime scene. Again, there was just smoke, a screwdriver, and a music box. Same for all the others.

### Chapter IV - Strange Ash

At the last crime, he gathered some strange ash. Back at ?HQ, he asked his supercomputer where it came from and it said that it came from underwater volcanoes. He went to the underwater volcanoes and what he saw was more than remains in the Titanic: it was a mine, an abandoned mine. But now he knew who was behind these crimes: his old nemesis...109.

### Chapter V - 109

109 likes to use underwater places as a base, leave unusual stuff, hack places, and use pieces of the environment as weapons. ? couldn't search the whole sea to find 109 so he went to the most likely place that 109 would be. Remember how the Titanic came up in the last chapter. Well here's why. ? was going to the Titanic.

### Chapter VI - The Titanic

At the Titanic, there was another abandoned base but there was a trail of volcano rocks. ? took out a drone that had a camera and directed it to follow the rock. He was going to check the place out, but all he saw was a note from 109 and it said:

*Welcome ?. I know that you sent that drone. I know you too well for you to beat me. Your drone will not find anything. You can't beat me. I know your every move even before you make it. You will never find me. Not even with Chief Lobster's help. Mua ha ha ha ha! Was that a good laugh? Wait, you can't hear me. Minions, take note that I have to start recording my messages! Wait, why am I writing this down? Anyway...Goodbye ?. Wait I'm supposed to say that when I'm about to destroy you. Bye for now.*

### Chapter VII - H.A.D.A.D.U.F.N.C Part 1

On his way back to ?HQ, he saw a sign that said H.A.D.A.D.U.F.N.C. At ?HQ, ? was trying to discover a clue that 109 wrote in his note. The handwriting looked like the president's hand writing. Just then, he remembered something.... He forgot his coffee. So he went to Starbucks and got himself a coffee. And when he returned to ?HQ, ? couldn't find anything,

## Chapter VIII · H.A.D.A.D.U.F.N.C Part II

Then back at ?HQ, he remembered that the writing looked like the president's writing. Because he remembered that he remembered something else and then something else and then something else. The first thing that he remembered was that ? knew the president, but when he got elected he started acting fishy for two things, (a) he started to sneak out without telling anyone and (b) he went on a diet and started eating a lot of fish.

## Chapter IX · H.A.D.A.D.U.F.N.C Part III

Right there when ? thought about going on a diet he now knew about H.A.D.A.D.U.F.N.C. because he is a detective and good at solving word puzzles. And then he figured what H.A.D.A.D.U.F.N.C. means. And it means helping to destroy the awesome digital universe for no cameras W.A.T.W.H. And W.A.T.W.H means Works at the White House..

## Chapter X · H.A.D.A.D.U.F.N.C Part IV

So he went over to the White House and he started investigating the guards and followed the workers, then the Vice president and last of all, he went to investigate the president. 109 was not a guard or a worker. If you were ? I bet you would feel betrayed. It was the president.

## Chapter XI · An Arrest

So ? called the police and the S.W.A.T. and the Military to arrest 109.  
Before 109 got in the car, he said, “This is not the last you will be seeing me.”

## Epilogue

Later back at ?HQ, a picture piped on a screen. It was a warehouse and in it was a bunch of boxes and then came a person. He looked oddly familiar. It was 109.

He said, “I told you this wasn’t the last you will be seeing me. And I brilliantly hacked your computer. You know you shouldn’t make your password and our google classroom class code the same. It’s too easy. I was top of the computer class.”

Then ? replied, “No you weren’t. You couldn’t even type.” Feeling insulted, 109 left. After that ? changed his passwords. Then he started to search for a sidekick.

**To Be Continued...**



# Dan the Detective

By Ashvin Kumar

One day, Dan the Detective was relaxing at the coffee and tea shop. This is where he would go everyday for coffee. Then, he got a call from Target.

“Hello, what has happened?”

“Hi Dan, somebody took many of our electrical items. We saw no one at our check-out tables with electric items. Can you help us find the robber?” The guy at Target asked.

“Sure! No problem,” Dan replied. He came upon a man who just went to Target. He knew he couldn't be the robber. He only had one bag that was halfway full. He asked him if before he left, he had seen anyone who had expensive or many electrical items.

“I saw two people,” the man said, “There was Sam with an electric scooter and Joe with a lawnmower.” Scott, the man that Dan was talking to, told Dan that he saw that Joe's lawnmower did not seem rusted and the tires seemed fresh. On the other hand, there was Sam's electric scooter, which was rusted but the tires seemed fresh. Dan was thinking that it was obvious that Joe was the robber, but he thought about it some more.

“What if the reason that Joe's lawnmower was in awesome shape was because he took care of it and bought new tires. Also, what if Sam rusted his scooter *or* painted it to look like it was rusted and the tires were the same as before?” So, Dan asked Scott where their houses were located and Scott told him the exact locations.

Once Dan made it to Joe's house, he saw his lawn mower. He used his super close-up magnifiers to check it. Like Scott said, the tires were totally fresh and there was no rust forming either. But then, he realized something about the tires and how the lawn mower was greased and then took a closer look at them with his magnifiers. He realized the tires were actually not the original ones and the chain was greased. He was good at spotting grease and oil on chains.

*Maybe Joe wasn't the robber after all!*

Then, he moved on to Sam's house. He also saw his electrical scooter. He used the magnifiers again to observe. As Scott told Dan, the tires seemed great, but the scooter was rusted. Suddenly, he realized something suspicious on the scooter. He saw the price tag! The Target people always rip off the price tag once the item is checked out. But for Sam, the price tag was still on!

Now that he knew who committed the crime, Dan arrested Sam for stealing many of Targets electrical items. He even inspected Sam's house and *boy* there were so many electrical items with price tags on. After Sam got arrested Dan thanked Scott for all the help he offered, went back to the coffee store to get his coffee for the day, and went back home to enjoy it.

**The End**



# THE CASE OF THE CRAZY CONCERT

By Annika Jivrajani

Hi. I am Luna. About a week ago something happened. Something big happened.

*"I found five dollars in my Jeans from last winter." (audience)*

Not what I'm talking about. I am talking about the crime that happened last week. You remember don't you?

*"Yes." (audience)*

You don't remember do you?

*"No, I don't."*

Just listen to the story. I discovered Pop Music.

*"Ok that's nice but finding five dollars is better."*

That's still not what I am talking about!! Here is how it started: It was recess and my other friend, Melony let me borrow her headphones.

I put them on and yelled, "What on earth was that?"

"It's RAD ROCKER," Melony said and told me all about them. But then she said the most amazing thing of all was that we were going to their concert.

"What? When? With whom?" I asked a lot of questions and then the most important question of all, "Can I come?"

"Sure! I'm buying the tickets tomorrow so you have to ask your dad tonight," said Melony. The next day, Melony got the tickets and I was really excited. And it was not just me. Everyone squashed around poor small Melony and she felt frightened. Luckily, Ms. Laursin was in the playground.

"Everyone move up," Ms. Laursin said. Melony did not like squashy crowds. After that, I decided to contain my excitement.

So when I went home I put the tickets in my special desk drawer. My dad said I could go to the concert before anyway. Then I waited nine whole hours until the concert came around. My friends came and I told them that my dad was making dinner, but I was too excited to eat. They came over so that we could get dressed in my room, so that we could go early because my dad read that there would be about 45 million people coming.

"Tickets are in the special drawer with work and badges and~Luna, remember to breathe," Melony said. I nodded as we went inside and ate. But Melony was the only one who could eat. And then, all the other girls got dressed. Liz did her braids, Kayla wore a little skirt and Melony brushed her teeth.

Then, I went to get the tickets.

"NOOOOOO THE TICKETS ARE GONE!" I yelled. We went to look for them and the girls retraced my steps.

Kayla said, "You got the tickets from Melony."

Liz said, "You put them in your special drawer."

Melony said, "...with your homework and badges."

Then, I started to look up and Liz said, "What, do you know where the tickets are?"

"No.... but Melony didn't you just say that there was homework and badges in it?" I responded.

"So? That's what you said. I only added the 'homework and badges' part so only Luna would know whether she took them or not, but why would she do that?"

Kayla said, "Wait. You put homework in your special desk drawer?"

"Yes, I do, but only the ones that I get an A+ on," I answered.

Melony said, "I don't want to go. I'm scared."

"This is my fault isn't it for telling you about how crowded it is. It is ok to tell someone if you are feeling anxious about something. Especially my dad. He is really good at this stuff," I said but Melony still decided to stay at home while we all left for the concert.

\*\*\*

"So was the concert good?" Melony asked some time later.

"It was more than good!" I exclaimed.

"It was amazing and my dad got me a really cool sweatshirt," I told Melony. When I'm not wearing it it would definitely go in our desk drawer for valuable things!

*Wait- where did she put the tickets?*

"In the bathroom she was not actually brushing her teeth, she was hiding the tickets.

*Ohh.*

That makes sense. And we found them right before the concert just in time. Well, another case CLOSED.

**The End.**

◆ **End of Spotlight Stories** ◆

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# Who is Hacking Everyone?

**By: Aarav Vashi**

There was a person who was hacking people and he was doing crazy things to everyone that he didn't like. The hacker's name was Alex. Alex played a lot of video games. He didn't like to lose so he would hack the game he was playing. He always won the game by hacking. Alex kept on hacking for 2 more years. But after 2 years, a new person named Spencer moved into his town.

The day he moved in, Spencer immediately got hacked. He was very confused about what was happening. Soon, he figured out that he was being hacked. He asked everyone if they were being hacked too or if it was just him. He figured out that someone was hacking everyone in the whole town. No one knew that the hacker was Alex. Spencer decided to figure out who the hacker was. The next day he started asking everyone if they knew any information about the hacker, but he got no information about the hacker from anyone in town. He went to each and every single house in the town. He asked each and every single person in town and everyone said what they knew.

He found out nothing but he figured out that 5 houses were quiet in the town. He figured out who lived in those houses. In one of the houses lived an old man and woman. In the other lived a little kid who was 11 and he didn't really show up to anything. In the third house lived a family who went on a vacation. In the fourth house lived a teenager and in the fifth house lived a family who were also on a vacation. Spencer was suspecting the teenager and the 11 year old boy.

The next day he went to the teenager's and the 11 year old kid's house. First he went to the teenager's house and he opened the door, then Spencer asked if he knew anything about a hacker in the town but he had no idea. When he went to the 11 year old kid's house, he didn't open the door. Then Spencer just realized that the 11 year old kid was the hacker. He called the cops and got the kid arrested for hacking. That day, Alex realized that if you do bad things to others, the same thing will happen to you.

## The End



# The Mystery of the Watch

By Arjun Mansukhani

There was once a person who stole a watch from a store because he really wanted to keep it and give it as a gift for his friend. His name was Miles.

So the next day, the people from the shop could not find the watch. Miles did not know this. The people who work at the shop were looking for the watch for days. Finally, they had found the watch, but the person wearing it was the one who received the watch.

The shop employees told him that this watch belonged to them, but the friend said, “No. I got this as a gift from a friend named Miles. See this is how he looks,” as he pulled out a picture of him.

After all the searching they found a hint: the street the house was on. When they knocked on the door, someone with the same name, Miles had opened it! And as they tried to bust in, the person in the house said, “Stop, this is my house. You can’t come in.”

The employees said, “Sorry” and walked away.

And on the last day of searching when they almost gave up, they finally found him and put him in jail.

He kept repeatedly saying, “I did not steal it. I did not steal it.”

However, he soon escaped again. There was a mask nearby and Miles put the mask on while they were asleep and ran away. They went looking again the next day. They looked everywhere until they found Miles in a truck hiding! And he went to jail and the crime was solved!



# The Two Smart Pigs

By Arna Srinivas

Once upon a time, there was a girl named Lilly. She was planning a birthday party with her friends. She bought her favorite type of cake, vanilla, for her birthday. It was also very expensive. Lilly couldn't wait for her birthday party, and out of nowhere these 2 very hungry pigs came over and took the cake away from her hand.

“Hey, give me my cake back!” shouted Lilly as they ran away.

“Ugh,” she sighed, “Now, I have to go back and get a new cake!” But, when she reached the bakery, she realized that she had no money left with her. “WHAT! This can’t be real!?!?” she sighed. “Now what am I gonna do?” she wondered.

When she was on her way home, she saw some frosting on the ground. “Oh no! Is that frosting from... MY CAKE!?!?” She asked herself. And as she went down the road, she saw many other foods like smooshed donuts, the sauce from the pizza, pasta, and many MORE! She said to herself, “Whoever stole my cake, is a big FOODIE! That means that the person who also took my friend Sally's cake pops is the same person who took my food! I better go and ask her who it was before she forgets!” Lilly ran. Once she reached, she saw a note on her door saying,

“ Dear Mrs. Lilly,

We are soo sorry about taking your cake. It just looked sooo tempting. We are again sorry about your inconvenience.

Regards,

The 2 foodie pigs :) ”

She had a not-so-happy face. “Oh well, looks like I can’t even have my birthday party!” she groaned. She went inside and said, “Sorry Guys, we won’t be having a party!” She ran to her room, locked her door, and cried.

Her very good friend Sally came over and knocked on the door. “Lilly, what happened?” asked Sally. Lilly opened the door and let Sally in.

“Remember, you told me about the 2 pigs that took your cake pops?” asked Lilly.

“Yeah, but what happened?”

“Well, they stole the cake!” exclaimed Lilly

“OH, THEN WHAT ARE U WAITING FOR? LET’S GO!” she yelled back. So, they ran, and ran, and ran.

“I think you’re talking about these pigs? Their names are Chelsea and Racheal,” she explained.

“Um....., I- don’t- NVM.” said Lilly with an unsure voice

“Ok then, Hello?” Sally asked the people who took Lilly’s cake.

“Oh, no girl, that girl came back. What is she going to do this time?!?” said Chelsea with a frightening voice.

“Shhh, be quiet! She is going to feel suspicious if she hears you!” said Racheal.

“Look, we didn’t do anything to you,” said Chelsea.

“You didn’t do anything to me, I came to ask if you guys did anything to my friend?” asked Sally.

“You know us, we tell the truth, we didn’t do anything to her!” explained Racheal.

“Ok fine! But just stay Couscous,” said Sally and so they went off. “Hmm, the people who stole your cake are VERY sneaky!” described Sally with a sure voice.

“But, I don’t know how to handle these sneaky guys. Do you know anybody that is good at trying to catch sneaky pigs?” Sally asked.

“That’s Christina of course!” said Lilly with a very happy voice. “That’s great, now we just have to go and ask her to help us,” smiled Sally and so they ran off once again.

**To Be Continued...**



## **BANK ACCOUNT ROBBED**

BY AVINASH KUMAR

“NOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO!” screamed Steve. Bob came running toward him and asked what happened.

Steve said, “My bank account was robbed. I should have paid attention to those security warnings.” Steve immediately called the police and told them what happened. The police hired a professional detective whose name was Ric. The police told Ric that someone robbed Steve's bank account.

Ric was already two steps ahead of them and went straight to his computer for clues. Steve opened his computer for Ric, but Ric typed in the password for him. Steve knew he would know because he can quickly find out anyone's password. Ric went in and saw millions of security alerts.

He asked Steve, “Did you even look at these?” Steve looked down at the floor and nodded.

“Next time you get one, you better pay attention to it,” Ric said. Bob was trying not to laugh at the back corner. Steve said that he needed to use the bathroom, and gave Bob a big shove on his shoulder and came back.

Ric scanned his device for anything else. He saw that his password was changed twice and they had no idea what it was anymore. Ric took Bob and Steve into his office. They all took a seat and Ric took his notepad out.

Steve even asked, “Can you tell me if my money is still in my account?” Ric opened his computer but they didn't know the password so they couldn't check if the money was there. Ric tried to hack the account but sure enough, it didn't work.

Ric got stressed and went to take a suitcase from his bag. He opened it and found the location of the hacker from his own tracker. They followed the location in a car and when they got there, they acted like they lived there, like any other normal person. Ric held the tracker in his hand and covered it with his suit so no one could see it. They went down the hall and found the hacker's room in a hotel. They asked the staff member for the card to the room and told him that he was a detective. The staff member immediately opened it and the hacker was caught red handed. He was on his computer in Steve's account and everyone was there to see it for themselves.

They forced him to tell them the password: “If you tell us, we will let you go,” which was obviously a lie, “and if you don't tell us, you are going straight to jail.” The hacker took no time and told them the password. Steve wrote it down in his pad and took him to jail.

Steve began to pay way more attention to the security alerts and erased every other device that was using his account except his own devices. Steve was not worried anymore and Bob and Steve went to Frozen Falls for a nice dessert.

*By Ayathi Magesh*

Mr. Larry was very worried because two gold blocks were worth about 10,000 dollars and they were stolen.

They were thinking and then realized that Rose who was their classmate also had red hair and decided to investigate her. They asked Rose lots of questions.

She said that she went to see a movie with her family.

“We have to investigate more,” Becky and Max said. Rocky was bored so he did not bother asking Rose questions. Becky and Max asked Rose why there was a red piece of hair at the Gold Place.

Then Becky thought, “Maybe it actually was not her!”

They continued searching and saw a book that had a laid out plan and the owner was RJ!

They were looking more and found a letter that said, “Grandma, are u ok?” Then they were thinking for forever when they realized that Josh’s grandma was sick.

That led them to investigate Josh, who said his grandma did not need money! They kept thinking about who could have done it. *Wait a minute*, they thought. *Rocky has red hair, RJ borrowed a book, and Josh's grandma needed money...*

**To Be Continued...**



## **The Magnificent Mini Golfer**

**By Kareena Patel**

Mckenzie, Summer, Lily and Mia were at the golf center to play some golf games. They were having so much fun when they saw Justin pressing down a sign that said get 100 balls in the hole and win 100 dollars. All of the girls jumped up and down. They tried many times but never got it.

After they were done, they went back to the Mystery City. Mystery city was the name of the place they work at. They were all 9 years old and made up the Mystery business in which people offered them jobs to solve mysteries and then got money. All of them loved their jobs.

*Knock Knock.* Summer jumped up and down like a crazy person. Whenever they got new customers, they were all so excited.

The boy, Justin walked in and said, "Somebody is cheating." The girls didn't know what was going on or who was cheating. Summer had one eyebrow up as she stood confused.

"Sorry if that was too abrupt. I meant that somebody is getting 100 balls in a row and I had to pay her 100 dollars and now I might lose my job."

"Why do you have to give her 100 dollars?" asked Lily.

"I put up a sign," said Justin.

"Oh we saw the sign," said Mia intermediately.

"So you mean that somebody is cheating at the golf course and you are paying them more than 100 dollars?"

"Yep," said Justin.

"We will come tomorrow morning at the golf center to help you," said Mia and Justin smiled. The next morning went by quickly and they finally arrived at the golf center.

"Hi Charlie," said Summer.

"Hi," Justin.

"Justin, can I please look at the scorecards of Ms. Taylor and Ms. Smith?"

"Sure."

"And can we also look around the golf course before Ms. Taylor and Ms. Smith come?"

*Clink.* Suddenly, they heard another sound.

## The End



By Kaushik Chavan

One good morning, Astro went to the library to get more space books with his friend Ben. After that, randomly the librarian gave Astro a watch. Ben and Astro asked why she gave Astro a watch. The librarian said that it was the last thing Astro's dad gave to her to give to him. Astro took the watch and pressed a button on the watch. The watch displayed "location: library."

The watch now read, “If you are my son, Astro, tell the librarian that we discovered the space center of the library. Say it in this exact way and take anyone you trust like your friend Ben.” Astro and Ben went to the librarian and said, “We discovered the space center of the library. ”

## To Be Continued...



## THE TREASURE PAINTING

BY LIKHITA M.

On a wonderful Autumn day, I heard an emergency phone call. I picked it up and a man's voice said to come to the museum immediately. I rushed into my car to the museum with my assistant. When I got there, I realized that one of the paintings was missing, specifically a picture of the ocean with a boat. It was long believed that the painting had a clue to treasure. There was also a letter there that said, "You know this person well."

I thought about the letter for a few days and so I went to my closest friends' houses but I found nothing. Well I didn't really get to stay at any house for long because my assistant kept dragging me. Today he said that it is probably at my family's house. When we got there it wasn't there. One of my friends wanted to help solve the mystery as well. She said that if she found any clues she would tell me. I said, "ok."

A few days passed and I didn't find any clues. One day my friend called me and asked if I checked my assistant's house and I said no. The next day I arrived at my assistant's house. He asked why I came, but I didn't respond. While I was searching, I found a small door and when I opened it my assistant tried to block me from going in. I insisted on going so I pushed him to the side and there I found the missing painting. He tried to give excuses but I didn't listen. I then took him to my office and asked him why he stole the painting. He said that he needed money.

Later, I went to his house and scanned it. I found a secret passage and a bunch of money and showed it to him. He didn't know what to say so he told me the truth, that he wanted to find the treasure from the painting, the treasure that the sailors left. So then we started arguing and then he finally decided that whoever finds the treasure first gets to keep. I didn't know what to say. He asked me if I wanted the deal or not and I said yes. Then I let him free and worked on plans to find the treasure somehow. I had the painting so I had a benefit, but he might have taken a picture so it wasn't good.

**To Be Continued...**



## ***THE ROBBERY***

***By LOHI NADELLA***

One day, there was a man named Wade and he was a detective so he solved many cases.

In Berkeley Heights, at 12:00 a.m., a mysterious man snuck into the bank without the security cameras knowing he was there. Then, he got a painful finger pincher and asked the person that had the key for the vault to open the vault. Afterwards, the police came and asked how the mysterious man looked. The person that opened the vault described him. They couldn't figure out how to solve the case so then at the last minute they asked Wade if he could crack the case. Wade said, "sure."

The next day Wade woke up and did his morning routine like he did everyday. Then, he dressed up for work and went to the crime scene. When he was investigating, he saw a little card and it said "Doctor Angelina." Then he spotted another thing at the end of the hallway. It looked just like his friend's pen and he was the only one who could have it because he made it by himself. Then, he said that if the robbers pen came up at the end of the hallway he had to be heading toward the back door, because he found that pen next to the backdoor. On the backdoor, he found a fingerprint and he had the police come there to see whose fingerprint it was. You wouldn't believe what Wade saw. It was his friend Jack's fingerprint. The police then arrested Jack and he explained that he was greedy and wanted more money. That is why he robbed the bank.

### **The End**



## **Greg Heffley, the Best Detective**

By: Malay Gupta

One day there was a person named Zball. Zball lost a box with some very special items in it, so he called Greg Heffley the detective and started to ask him if he could help find his box of special things.

Greg said, "I'm on the case." Greg went to Zball's house to get clues from his house. Greg found a few footprints which lead to the back door that then led straight to a broken hole in the fence and a pair of gloves nearby. Greg went to his office to test the fingerprint on the gloves, the machine could not detect any fingerprint so Greg kept looking for other clues.

Greg found another clue In Zball's house, it was a piece of hair.

"The color is green and it is soft, so it could be someone's from our city because that type of hair is common in our city," Greg said. So Greg started to take a test on the hair piece and got a few details of the person. Greg was with the same person a long time ago so he already had his number. He used phonetracker.com to track down his location, but he was underground so the signal was lost. However, the man seemed to have gone back up some time later, so now he was able to track him again.

Greg found him by using phonetracker.com and he was at the town hall so Greg drove there, found him, cuffed him, and drove him to jail. Greg gave the box back to Zball. The items inside the box were all of the Diary of a Wimpy Kid books. Zball was so happy after getting his precious collection back. Now he wants to go home to pre-order the new Diary of a Wimpy Kid - The Deep End, which is coming out on October 27, so that he could add it to his collection. Greg the detective will be back with more stories.

### **The End**



## *The Last Painting*

*By Oviya Olinilavan*

It was a lot of money. They all were worth a lot of money. All of them could be lost forever. So they had to do something about it.

Three kids were watching some TV. Then, suddenly, the news channel was on. It reported a missing painting that was worth five thousand dollars. The museum was famous for its paintings and the kids were interested. These specific kids LOVED mysteries very much.

It was summer break now and they lived right next to the museum. Soooo this meant...ANSWERS. This might not be a boring summer after all!

These kids were friends, not family, though they treated each other like family. I should probably say their names, right? The first one was Amy, second Jason, and the third Lily, they were all 10 years old.

Lily's dad was a police officer so she and her friends were allowed in the area where the painting once was. After a lot of begging, they finally got to go to the museum to check the painting area and look for shoe prints and even more. There were no clues no matter how hard they looked. It was night already. After three more checks, still nothing was there. They gave up looking and decided to let the adults handle this. Sure they solved many mysteries before, but this one was the biggest and hardest.

They were about to leave but then the doors of the museum closed.

They heard creaking... Jason whispered, "follow me." They did not know what to do so they followed Jason. They hid behind a statue. They saw this guy going to the painting section. His movements were very eerie: *step wait wait wait step wait wait wait*. He was very careful, he reminded them of someone they knew. They watched him very carefully, hoping that this might be their chance to find out who he is. But the question was, would they ever figure it out?

He was dressed in black like any criminal. He wore a mask and hid in the shadows. He went to a painting with no guards. The guards were busy moving to make sure everything was in

order. His feet looked dirty, but he did not notice. He was too busy looking at everything. He had noticed that his gloves were dirty so he had to take them off. Amidst all the silence, the clock was ticking and their heart was beating: *Tick pound tick pound tick pound tick pound*.

As every second passed, he was closer and closer. Soon, he could touch the painting. He quietly took the painting and snuck away. The guards were busy somewhere else so he had escaped. He was too big for the kids to catch so they did not move. They decided to stay at the museum to investigate some more, and rested down to sleep. It had been one long night.

They woke up early so they could look around. They found a hair sample. Lily said that she had some bags to put the hair in. They got the bag and put the hair sample in. As for the shoe print, they got a big bag, carefully put it on the shoe print, and got it to stick to the bag. Lily's dad found them and they told him everything that happened. The hair sample was brown. There were only two people that they *knew* with brown hair: Mr. Henry and John.

It was surprising how many people had brown hair. They tried looking everywhere for fingerprints, but there were none. The thief even took off his gloves. He took off his gloves! *His gloves!!* What type of criminal is he? Clearly, not experienced.

Back to the story. They called Lily's dad and he actually thought it could be either Mr. Henry or John. The most obvious choice would be Mr. Henry because he was so secretive. He was always in his house but was friends with Lily. John was a babysitter and always brought happiness to everyone. When they came to the meeting, both of them looked nervous. They wore their shoes which was good so they could check shoe prints. They were asked to give their shoes over. Mr. Henry was hesitant and probably would have said no but he finally gave in. *Suspicious, very suspicious*. They checked that shoe with the other shoe print and ... It matched Mr. Henry! Amy was shocked, Jason was furious and Lily was ... was blank. Tears were down on her cheeks and her hands were in fists, her face shocked.

"How could you?" she asked Mr. Henry who said nothing. The police took him away. This is when the three kids got a name for their team "J.A.L Mysteries: Jason, Amy, and Lily" or "Just Amazing Light." They were getting awarded in the museum because that's where they solved the mystery. They could never forget that day.

But then ... they saw a fingerprint at the crime scene. They realized that the person could have easily swapped the shoe print but a fingerprint would help solve the case for sure. They had to go and double check.

"STOP!" they all yelled. They asked to check the fingerprint. You could hear a pin drop at that time, all the small sounds that you normally wouldn't hear. *Tick tick tick tick tick tick tick*. A test showed that the fingerprint did not match Mr. Henry's! But, it did match John. *He always (sniff) did good (sniff) things to (sniff) others*. He said he did it for the money so he could give it to charity. Now that they had successfully solved the case, the kids shouted, "J.A.L Mysteries, Just Amazing Light!"

**The End**



# **The Robbery**

## **By Siddharth Rayachoti**

Once, there was a rich man named Bucky Barnes in San Francisco. One day, a Range Rover Evoque, which had 2 large diamonds and \$5,000,000 in a briefcase, was stolen from his house. Bucky filed a complaint at the police station about his loss. The police handed over the case to a very famous detective, her name was Hela Odin. She asked Bucky a few questions and requested if she could come to his house and investigate the case. Bucky agreed, Hela investigated for a long time, finding and searching for answers. There were so many things to investigate, because Bucky's house was very big!

She checked the CCTV footage and saw a familiar symbol, that meant 100% bad news. In her last case, she found a criminal named Allen with the same symbol so she immediately went to Allen's cell in the San Francisco State Prison. She asked him what the symbol meant, and he refused to answer. Hela threatened to pull out her taser. Shakingly Allen said, "It means that a member of blood globins is committing a crime."

Then she asked, "Where will your team base be?" He responded, "There are 5,000 bases in California. I only know my base's location, Medicine Lake Volcano, in San Jose." She went there with many police officers. When they went in the base there was nobody there, but there were a few cars that were stolen from bamacama galu. There was a map to the main base in San Nicolas Island, a part of the US army. They attacked the base and got all the stolen stuff including Bucky's car!

**The End**

